Cotton trousers
Male and female Viet Cong were virtually indistinguishable in their loose black cotton trousers. Mens' trousers, like those shown here, were fastened by means of a drawstring round the waist.





Hole drilled in base of rice bowl to attach it to the backpack

Camouflage ring

Backpack
Although the Viet Cong usually travelled with the minimum of personal possessions, some carried a small rucksack. The ring, made of wood and wire bound with cloth, was designed to hold small branches, twigs, and leaves as camouflage to break up the guerrilla's silhouette.



Straps made of rubber or cloth

Rubber sandals
Standard VC footwear was a pair of sandals made from old rubber tyres, far from adequate protection in a jungle environment. In contrast, soldiers of the North Vietnamese Army (NVA) were issued with hard-wearing jungle boots.

Sole made from recycled tyre treads



Drinking cup that fits over base of the canteen

Canvas cover

ENAMELLED CANTEEN AND CUP

ALUMINIUM WATER BOTTLE

Water bottles
The Viet Cong were not issued with any standard canteen, but used a wide range of cheap water bottles, most of them manufactured in China.



Water bottle attached to ammo belt



Hand grenade pouch worn over the shoulder



Enamelled rice bowl

Basket for steaming

Cooking and eating
Every Viet Cong guerrilla would normally have his or her own rice bowl, usually made of enamelled steel. Cooking equipment was kept to a minimum, though lightweight baskets for carrying and also for steaming food were common.

